

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments and collection product specialist.*

Positioning, ten years of cross-functional product delivery in regulated, data-intensive environments – now focused on building fair, scalable payment journeys at scale.

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§ WHY RIVERTY

Riverty sits at an intersection that genuinely interests me: consumer empathy, payment infrastructure, and intelligent automation – not as marketing language, but as operating principles embedded in a collection product. The posting names AI-supported decisioning, workflow automation, and self-service as concrete roadmap directions, which maps directly to where I have spent the last two years. Bertelsmann family ownership also means long-term investment in product quality over quarterly exit pressure – a meaningfully different environment than most FinTech competitors. *That is the kind of structural patience where careful, systematic product work actually compounds.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked inside a debt collection business before, and the regulatory specificities of the German Inkasso environment are not something I can claim first-hand. What I do carry is a demonstrated pattern of translating complex regulatory and stakeholder constraints into scalable, automated product logic – at a public-sector analytics platform, an InsurTech SaaS with Erstversicherer clients, and a defence programme with multinational compliance requirements. The mechanic is the same; the domain vocabulary differs and I will close that gap quickly.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, structured requirements, spec generation, edge-case coverage
- **GPT**, research synthesis and stakeholder document drafts
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted development and review
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for discovery
- **n8n**, multi-agent workflow and automation design
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing product narratives
- **Framer**, interactive wireframes and concept validation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, JavaScript, Kotlin, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, REST APIs, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Helm, Terraform, AngularJS, Ionic – across public sector analytics, defence AI platforms, InsurTech SaaS, and mobile healthcare.

§ SIDE PROJECT

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Group-based P2P payments on a P2P backbone – acquired and operated by Sparkasse.

- Built the full payment flow end-to-end: group creation, settlement calculation, PSP integration, and edge-case handling for partial payments and contested splits.
- Designed the UX and mobile app prototype with a focus on reducing friction in social payment contexts.
- Integrated a third-party PSP into a bespoke P2P backbone – including deposit, withdrawal, and reconciliation flows.
- Directly relevant to Riverty's self-service payment journey work: the hard problems of consumer payment UX, failure states, and trust-building under financial stress are the same.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT RIVERTY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the operations team on live collection cases, read existing KPI dashboards, and interview two or three internal stakeholders – specifically around where manual process steps still live inside nominally automated payment journeys.

WEEK 2

Audit and prioritise.

Map the current installment and self-service payment flows against user drop-off data and ops intervention rates, identify the three highest-leverage automation or UX improvements, and draft an initial discovery backlog with hypotheses attached.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Align the first roadmap increment with Tech and Data, run the discovery cycles needed to de-risk it, and establish a rhythm of transparent stakeholder updates so adjacent product teams and operations can plan around our delivery.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Riverty Hiring Team,

The Product Manager Installments & Payments role caught my attention because the core challenge – designing payment agreements that are simultaneously fair to consumers, operationally scalable, and economically sound – is exactly the kind of systemic problem I find most compelling. It is not a UX polish exercise; it requires holding regulatory constraints, decisioning logic, and user psychology in tension at the same time.

My background gives me a credible starting position for this. At the Federal Employment Agency I owned an analytics platform serving regional labour market data to policy-makers, where every product decision had to survive scrutiny from data governance, IT security, and politically sensitive stakeholders simultaneously. I introduced Dagster-based ETL automation, reduced manual indicator-generation steps, and served as Deputy IT Security Officer – meaning I lived the intersection of data quality, compliance, and product velocity for over a year. At

Rohde & Schwarz I delivered AI and data transformation tooling under a defence programme, where auditability and explainability were not optional features but first-class requirements. Both environments trained me to treat regulation as a design constraint rather than a blocker.

The installment and self-service angle of this role maps closely to work I did at Kvitt Payment Solutions, a P2P group payment product I co-founded and later saw acquired by Sparkasse. Building consumer payment flows from scratch – including PSP integration, settlement logic, and the edge cases that only appear when real users are stressed about money – gave me a practical understanding of where self-service breaks down and what it actually takes to make it robust. I understand why the last ten percent of a payment journey is harder than the first ninety.

At Emil Group I re-established delivery discipline in a struggling InsurTech environment: split a bloated seventeen-person team, reintroduced velocity tracking, and rebuilt client trust through structured product workshops. The parallel to orchestrating Tech, Data, Operations, Legal, and customer-facing teams at Riverty is direct. I have learned that the organisational side of product management – aligning stakeholders on priorities, making decisions transparent, and creating structures that let teams work with autonomy – is often harder than the product design itself, and I take it as seriously.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background fits what your team is building. I am based in Berlin, German is my first language, and I can start within four weeks of an offer.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience turning complex operational and regulatory requirements into scalable, automated software systems. Background spans regulated public-sector analytics, defence AI platforms, InsurTech SaaS, and consumer payment products. Comfortable leading cross-functional teams without direct authority, establishing delivery discipline under pressure, and driving data-informed product decisions. Fluent in AI-native tooling and technical enough to unblock engineering conversations independently.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Translating regulatory and operational complexity into scalable product logic

- Payment flow design and PSP integration product ownership
 - Data-driven product discovery and KPI-oriented prioritisation
 - Cross-functional stakeholder alignment without line authority
 - Delivery discipline: backlog management, sprint structure, velocity tracking
 - AI-native workflow integration and automation design
 - Process mining, BI tooling, and ETL pipeline product ownership
 - Establishing documentation, standards, and enablement structures
 - Founder-level pragmatism: high agency, low ego, moves fast under ambiguity
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned data provenance, transformation transparency, and audit trail requirements for a defence-grade AI platform – directly analogous to the explainability and compliance demands in regulated payment decisioning
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout
- Reduced deployment cycle from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing ArgoCD-based GitOps
- Unblocked infrastructure issues in OpenShift independently; delivered a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year – completed in one week
- Led a cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA with multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Drove feature delivery on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor, an analytics platform for regional labour market and demographic data used by policy stakeholders across Germany
- Automated ETL and indicator generation pipelines with Dagster, reducing manual steps and improving data reliability
- Designed interactive dashboards, flexible regional comparison views, and community features; managed major Kubernetes migration and system upgrades
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with responsibility for compliance, governance, and data lineage – built experience navigating regulatory requirements as product constraints
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration, improving release stability

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation for primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, and brokers
- Designed and shipped a Claims Center module from concept to production
- Re-established sprint discipline in a struggling delivery environment: split a 17-person team into focused Scrum units, introduced ownership and deputy structures, reintroduced velocity tracking
- Rebuilt client trust through weekly structured product workshops; reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport coordination, chat, and document storage – across iOS and Android
- Integrated a CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, navigating legacy API constraints under tight deadlines
- Built stakeholder confidence through transparent communication of technical complexity and delivery trade-offs

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product end-to-end: payment flow, PSP integration, settlement logic, UX and mobile prototype
- Navigated all edge cases of consumer payment behaviour – partial payments, contested splits, failure states – and designed self-service flows that required no support escalation for the happy path
- Product was later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware

- Key USP: setup under two minutes, no technical knowledge required – enforced radical simplicity under complex cryptographic constraints
- Served as deputy IT security officer

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR

- Co-founded and operated a nanotechnology startup across product, finance, HR, and investor relations
- Introduced ERP and full digital tooling stack; led financial planning and investment rounds

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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